FOUR AGAINST DARKNESS

The Dungeon Dive

PLAY REFERENCE

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Phases A–H, in play order

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PAGE NUMBERS ARE PRINTED BOOK PAGES

❖ Codes & tiers

Book codes

CODE	FILE	CODE	FILE
4AD	`4ad-core-book-expanded.pdf`	**CoC**	`…caverns-of-chaos`
4AA	`…four-against-the-abyss`	**DDD**	`…devouring-dead`
NW	`…four-against-the-netherworld`	**RoR**	`…ravagers-of-ruins`
FD	`Stand Alone Books/…forsaken-depths`	**CCC**	`…crucible-of-classic-critters`
TDoor	`…twisted-doors`	**MMM**	`…more-mountainous-mayhem`
TDun	`…twisted-dungeons`	**LTQ**	`…lost-temples-of-qaarra`
TCav	`…twisted-caverns`	**SSS**	`…swamps-of-the-slithering-snakemen`
TTun	`…twisted-tunnels`	**TTT1 / TTT2**	`…troublesome-towns-tome-i / -ii`
TMin	`…twisted-minions`	**OWQ**	`overland-world-quest-generation…`
THoard	`…twisted-hoards`	**OA**	`overland_adventures.pdf`
TTrap	`…twisted-traps-and-snares`	**Atlas**	`…dungeon-atlas-vol1`
TFF	`…twisted-final-fights` *(image-only — print it)*	**Dozen**	`…dreadful-dozen` / `…frightful-dozen`

`4AD 152` = that book, printed page 152.

Tier ladder

LEVELS	TIER	DIE	EXPLODES ON	BOOK
1–4	1 Basic	d6	6	**4AD**
5–9	2 Expert	d8	7+	**4AA** (hex side-arc: **NW**, L6–9)
10–14	3 Heroic	d10	8+	**FD**
15–19	4 Legendary	d12	9+	**FD**
20+	5 Epic	d20	10+	**FD**

Tier number · Tier dice · Explosion: **4AD 5**. HCL system: **4AD 3**. Tier summary table: **FD 4**.

1 Adventure Order

A — Before play

#	DO	LOOK UP
A1	Build 4 PCs	**4AD 8** (choosing) · classes **4AD 19–65**
A2	Note each PC's default weapon, armour, Marching Order 1–4	Marching Order **4AD 95**
A3	Buy gear. Lantern + **2 torches** (2gp ea) · **door wedges** 5gp · crowbar 25gp	Lantern **4AD 110** · gear **TDoor 16**
A4	Set the limit: tile count or clock	—
A5	Draw the tally box for Major Foes	Final Boss **4AD 105**

B — Choose the destination

#	DO	LOOK UP
B1	Move a hex, roll terrain	**OWQ** Overland Hex Generation
B2	Roll **2d6** Special Features (road / roadless table)	**OWQ** Special Features
B3	Settlement? d6 → **1–3 Village · 4–5 Town · 6 City**	**OWQ**; town play **TTT1**
B4	Taking a quest? d20 quest → d6 **type** → d6 **size** → d6 layout	**OWQ** Quest Generation
B5	Dungeon type → pick the table set	**§4** below

Type → book: Dungeon → **4AD / CoC / DDD** · Cavern → **TCav** · Ruins (open air) → **RoR** · Woodland (open air) → **CCC** · Catacombs → multi-level fan module · Ancient Crypt → **OWQ App.7 + DDD**

C — Enter

#	DO	LOOK UP
C1	Roll **Dungeon Door Strength** d6 once: 1–2 weak · 3–4 average · 5–6 secure	**TDoor 2**
C2	*(optional)* Roll one dungeon complication	**TDun 3–33**
C3	Roll **1d6 First Room**, draw it — **no content roll**	Tile generation **4AD 149**

D — Tile loop · repeat

#	DO	LOOK UP
D1	Pick an exit	—
D2	**Door:** d6 → 1–4 material · 5–6 roll **d88**	**TDoor 2–15**; simple 2d6 table **4AD 109**
D3	Roll **d66 tile shape**, draw it. 1 sq wide = corridor · 2+ = room	**4AD 149**
D4	Roll **2d6 Tile Content**	**4AD 152** · §2
D5	Resolve: fight → **E** · trap → **§2** · treasure → **§2** · event → **4AD 154–156**	
D6	Empty? **Search once**, mark "S"	**4AD 107**; caverns **4AD 113**
D7	Repeat D1. Backtracking = 1-in-6 Wandering Monsters	**4AD 104**

E — Encounter

#	DO	LOOK UP
E1	Roll the Foe on the environment's table	§4
E2	Attack now, **or** gamble on a Reaction roll	Surprise / who goes first **4AD 90**
E3	Order: Foe ranged (if surprised) → PC ranged & spells → Foe melee → PC melee	**4AD 91**, flowchart **4AD 146**
E4	Declare each PC's attack **after** seeing the last result	Attacking **4AD 91**
E5	Assign Foe attacks	**4AD 96–97**
E6	Minor Foes below half → Morale d6: **1–3 flee** (you still get treasure)	Fleeing Foes **4AD 95**
E7	Out: **Withdraw** (needs a door, +1 Defense) or **Flee** (gear lost on deaths)	**4AD 97**

F — Final Boss

#	DO	LOOK UP
F1	Each Major Foe: d6 **+1 per Major Foe met**. **6+ = the Boss**	**4AD 105**
F2	Out of grid → Boss is in the last tile automatically	**4AD 105**
F3	Boss: **+1 Life, +1 attack, fights to the death**, gold ×3 or 100gp, 2 magic items	**4AD 105**
F4	*(optional)* Escalate	**TFF** · Final Boss Table play aid

G — Walk out

#	DO	LOOK UP
G1	Every tile back = 1-in-6 Wandering Monsters	**4AD 107**
G2	Secret door shortcut: roll d6, on a **6** you exit with no WM roll	**4AD 108**
G3	Count XP	**4AD 117** · §3

H — Town & next

#	DO	LOOK UP
H1	Roll before/after-dungeon events	Random Events play aid
H2	Town: light version **OWQ** Settlement Actions · full version **TTT1 + TTT2**	hamlets **TTT1 21**
H3	Shop, heal, resurrect (1000gp, can fail)	**4AD 105**, 111
H4	Level up, spend XP	**4AD 117–118**
H5	Advance the plot, pick the next hex → back to **B**	**OWQ**

2 The Rolls

Tile Content — 2d6 · 4AD 152

2D6	RESULT
2	Treasure
3	Trapped treasure — traps **then** treasure
4	Corr: empty · Room: **Special Event**
5	Empty + **Special Feature**, or Secret Passage
6	**Vermin**
7	**Minions**
8	Corr: empty · Room: **Minions**
9	Empty; or **2 Clues** → Secret Passage
10	Corr: empty · Room: **Weird Monster**
11	**Boss**
12	Corr: empty · Room: **dragon's lair**

Search — d6, −1 in corridors · 4AD 107

D6	RESULT
0–1	**Wandering Monsters**
2–4	Nothing
5–6	Choose: hidden treasure · secret door · secret passage · **1 Clue**

Once per tile. Halfling may spend 1 Luck to reroll. **3 Clues = 1 Secret = 1 XP** (**4AD 109**). Caverns/grottoes 5–6 differs — **Listen** and pre-roll the next tile: **4AD 113**, **TCav 11–12**.

Wandering Monsters — d6 · 4AD 107

D6	FOE
1–2	Vermin
3–4	Minions
5	Weird Monster
6	**Boss**

They attack first; no shield bonus on that roll. Triggered by: Search 0–1 · backtrack 1-in-6 · bash roll of 1 · treasure alarm · Rest 1-in-6 · dragging a petrified PC 2-in-6 · Echo tile 2-in-6.

Hidden treasure · 4AD 108

`(2d6+HCL) × (2d6+HCL)` gp. Roll the complication **first**: 1–2 alarm · 3–5 trapped (Save vs. HCL+1, −1 Life, −2 on a 1) · 6 guardian ghost (cleric Saves vs. HCL, else all PCs −1 Life).

Doors

Simple: 2d6 table, **4AD 109**. **Full: TDoor**.

TDoor procedure: Dungeon Door Strength once on entry (**TDoor 2**) → per door d6, **1–4 material, 5–6 roll d88**. Materials 11–18 = **TDoor 2–3**; the 41 special doors 21–88 = **TDoor 4–15**; gear = **TDoor 16**.

D88	MATERIAL	LOCKED	PICK / BASH	SPELLS
11	Woven straw	1-in-6	2	Slash/flame auto, **no WM**
12	Tied branches	1-in-6	d6+1	Slash/flame auto, 1-in-6 WM
13	Wood plank	2-in-6	d6+2	Fireball/Lightning destroy, 1-in-6 WM
14	Solid wood	2-in-6	d6+2+Tier	as above
15	Reinforced wood	3-in-6	d6+3+Tier	destroyed on spell roll = lock difficulty
16	Metal bars	4-in-6	pick 5+Tier+d6 · bash d6+5	Fireball no; Lightning → weathered (#66)
17	Solid metal	5-in-6	d6+Tier+4	bashing loud — **WM on 1–3**
18	Stone	always	d6+Tier+5	immune; **dwarves +L to bash**

Bash: a roll of **1 brings Wandering Monsters**. Crowbar +1 · battering ram +1+1d3. **Warp Wood** (druid, *Wayfarers & Adventurers*) destroys any wooden door up to reinforced; 2-in-6 WM.

Traps & treasure — core pages

ROLL	DUNGEON	CAVERNS	FUNGAL GROTTO
Traps	**4AD 164**	**4AD 165**	**4AD 166**
Treasure	**4AD 157**	—	—
Magic treasure	**4AD 158**	**4AD 160**	**4AD 161**
Special feature	**4AD 153**	—	—
Special events	**4AD 154**	**4AD 155**	**4AD 156**

Outdoor traps: **TTrap** (d66, wilderness only). Bigger hauls: **THoard**. Quests **4AD 162** · Epic rewards **4AD 163**.

Monster tables — core pages

	VERMIN	MINIONS	WEIRD	BOSS
Dungeon	**167**	**168**	**169**	**170**
Caverns	**171**	**172**	**174**	**173**
Fungal grotto	**175**	**176**	**178**	**177**
Fiendish Foes	**181**	**182**	**184**	**183**

Fiendish Foes section **4AD 179–186** · Bosses with minions **4AD 180** · minion variety **TMin** · unique named foes **Dozen**.

3 Combat Card

Summaries: attack mods 4AD 147 · defense mods 4AD 148 · initiative flowchart 4AD 146.

Attack · 4AD 91

WHO	BONUS
Warrior · barbarian · dwarf · elf · paladin	**+L**
Partial martial (e.g. cleric)	**+½L**
Cleric vs. undead	**+L**
Rogue vs. outnumbered Minor Foe	**+L**
Wizard melee	none; +L on spells; light weapons −1
Unarmed 4AD 93	**−2**
No light 4AD 93	**−2**

Two-handed +1 · light −1 · crushing vs. skeletons +1 (**4AD 93**).

Damage · 4AD 94

- **Minor Foe** (1 Life): total ÷ L, rounded down = **number killed**.
- **Major Foe**: 1 damage, **+1 per further multiple** of its L.
- Major Foe under **½ Life → L−1**.

Defense · 4AD 97

MODIFIER	
Light armour	+1
Heavy armour	+2
Shield	+1
Rogue	+L
Dwarf vs. troll/giant	+1
Halfling vs. troll/giant/ogre	+L

A roll of 1 always fails. A 6 is not an auto-success but explodes.

Who gets attacked · 4AD 96–97

SITUATION	ATTACKS
Room, Foes < PCs	each a different PC; **you** choose who is spared
Room, equal	one each
Room, Foes > PCs	spread evenly, you assign extras — **except Hated classes**
Corridor	**max 2 Foes**, hitting positions 1–2
Wandering Monsters in corridor	2 of them hit positions **3–4**

Hatreds: trolls/goblins/kobolds → dwarves · orcs → elves · undead → clerics. **Outnumbered? Back into a corridor.**

XP · 4AD 117

SOURCE	XP
10 Minor Foe encounters	1
Secret revealed (3 Clues)	1
Each Major Foe	1
Final Boss	+1

Slower options: **4AD 117–118**. Or cap at 1 Level per adventure.

Conditions

	RULE	PAGE
Rest	Once per adventure. Cleared room, adjacent tiles clear, doors nailed or **wedged**. +1 Life or 1 ability each, then 1-in-6 WM	**4AD 114**
Madness	1+ = no equipment trading. Above L → PC is gone (wizards L+1). L1–4 may take 2 damage instead	**4AD 113**
Fallen	Strip gear 1 turn. Carrying a body = that PC auto-hit, no Defense. Resurrect 1000gp, can fail	**4AD 105**
Petrified	Needs a Blessing. 2 PCs to carry, 2-in-6 WM	**4AD 106**

4 Environment → Table Set

ENVIRONMENT	OPEN	PAGES
Dungeon	**4AD**	152–170
Dungeon, chaos/goblinoid (L3–6)	**CoC**	tables 11–25, missions 5–9
Dungeon, undead	**DDD**	room contents 87, tables 88–126, tiles 27
Cavern	**TCav** + **4AD**	TCav 2–12; 4AD 112–113, 171–174
Fungal grotto	**4AD**	113, 175–178
Tunnels	**TTun**	—
Ruins / open air	**RoR**	—
Woodland / open sky	**CCC**	—
Mountains (L4+)	**MMM**	—
Swamp	**SSS**	—
Temple (L6+)	**LTQ**	—
Under a town	**TTT2** Undercity tables	139–141
Abyss (L5–9)	**4AA**	46–61

Secret Passages let you change environment mid-dive — use one pencil colour per table set. Pre-drawn maps instead of rolling: **Atlas**. Dungeon twists: **TDun**.

5 Town — Ttt

NEED	PAGE
Steps of play	**TTT1 15**
Town size · blocks	**TTT1 20**
Hamlet rules (1 block, d6+1 tiles, no Undercity)	**TTT1 21**
True towns (4+ blocks)	**TTT1 22**
Walk the town · map icons	**TTT1 25**
Worked example (hamlet)	**TTT1 34**
Connected Dungeons — run DDD / CoC / TDun in the Undercity	**TTT1 74**
Dungeon Transit — town→dungeon = d6+HCL days	**TTT1 77**
Factions	**TTT1 150**
Vicious Villains	**TTT1 166–187**, roster **TTT2 144**
Undercity tables	**TTT2 139–141**
Hamlet flowchart	**TTT2 182**

Villains: Crazy Collector **173** · Grim Guildmaster **176** · Hidden Horror **179** · iNsAnE iNvEnToR **181** · Warped Warmaster **183** · Wicked Warlock **186**.

6 Above Tier 1 — 4Aa

NEED	PAGE
Stepping into the Abyss	**4AA 4**
Exploding d8s	**4AA 4**
Start a party at L5	**4AA 7**
Minions with leaders	**4AA 7**
Multiple bosses in a room	**4AA 9**
Trial of Champions	**4AA 9**
Hordes	**4AA 10**
Expert Skills	**4AA 14–22**, summary **62**
Turn Undead · Vampire Hunter · Orcslayer	**4AA 22 · 22 · 20**
Hirelings & retainers	**4AA 26–33**, costs **64**
Madness · Vampirism · Dark Plague · Lycanthropy	**4AA 34 · 36 · 37 · 39**
Abyss tables	**4AA 46–61**

Heroic/Legendary: **FD** — tier rules **FD 2**, tier summary **FD 4**, Heroic Skills **FD 6–17**, Heroic Magic **FD 18**, Legendary Skills **FD 20**.

7 Eleven Rules Of Thumb

1. Set the tile or time limit **before** you start.
2. Carry spare torches — no light is **−2 to everything** and no Searching.
3. Door wedges (5gp, reusable) beat nails (4gp, single use).
4. Outnumbered → fight in a **corridor**. 4 Foes become 2 attacks.
5. Don't backtrack casually — every re-entered tile rolls on a table with a Boss on it.
6. Attack **one PC at a time**, watching each result.
7. Reaction rolls are a gamble: a Fight result means they swing first.
8. Search every safe empty tile. Clues are XP and keys; secret doors **double** treasure.
9. Remember the hatreds — a dwarf in a goblin dungeon soaks every spare attack.
10. Fleeing works: **HCL locks on first contact**, so a hard room stays that L when you return.
11. Budget the walk home. The Boss is not the last fight.

Two or three add-ons per dungeon

One environment book, one bestiary, one spice. Everything else stays on the shelf.

DUNGEON	ENVIRONMENT	BESTIARY	SPICE
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			